

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Traditions are what makes a country truly unique!



Learning Outcome

Accurately use information about people's backgrounds in a wider variety of communicative situations.

Ask your partner:

- What are your country's most popular traditions? Are they religious festivals? Public holidays?
- Which tradition do you like best? Why?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about cultural items, icons and events.
- I can talk about things that I'm supposed to do and things that are supposed to happen.
- I can explain my opinion.





Let's Explore!

Jose shares some of Colombia's **best-kept secrets***.

* A "best-kept secret" is something very good that not many people know about.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Jose:** How was that shepherd's pie?
- Jessica:** It was delicious. Thanks for the suggestion. I shouldn't eat this every week, though! It's better not to worry about that, right?
- Jose:** Exactly! Just enjoy life. That's what we do in Colombia.
- Jessica:** I heard there are a lot of festivals and celebrations.
- Jose:** Oh yes! They are not to be missed. You can start with the Black and White Festival in January.
- Jessica:** What is that? I'm not sure I've heard about it.
- Jose:** It's a 3-day carnival held in the city of Pasto, in southeastern Colombia. It showcases a mixture of indigenous rituals and Spanish colonial traditions. On the last day, the revelers paint each other black and large quantities of white talcum powder are thrown all over the city.
- Jessica:** That sounds fun!
- Jose:** You should really see it. It's not something you experience every day.
- Jessica:** I also heard there were a lot of religious processions.
- Jose:** Yes, of course. The Catholic influence is still very strong in Colombia. It is part of our ancestry. Our Easter celebrations are very traditional. We're supposed to think about the religious meaning of Easter. We don't have the bunny like you do here!
- Jessica:** Very funny.
- Jose:** We also take our beauty pageants seriously. For example, we crown a Queen of Coffee every year during the Manizales Festival in January.
- Jessica:** Well, we certainly do not have that in Boston ...



Let's Practice!

Jessica and Jose talk about festivals.

Instructions: Read the sentences. Find the words from the Word Bank to correctly complete the sentences.

Word Bank

to try / costumes / religious meaning / to drink / go to

1. You are supposed to think about the _____ of Easter.
2. I'm supposed to _____ Bogota for two months.
3. My friends said I am supposed _____ all kinds of food.
4. Are people supposed to wear _____ during that festival?
5. Revelers are not supposed _____ alcohol on the streets.



Let's Practice!

Colombia is a place you should not miss.

Instructions: Proofread the sentences. Correct the mistakes. Practice yourself saying the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. day / not / you / It's / . / experienced / something / every

2. it / I'm / hearing / I've / not / about / . / sure

3. that / worried / better / not / to / , / right / It's / ? / about

4. have / not / certainly / Boston / does / . / that / in / We

5. festival / heard / I / there / a / in / lot / Boston / . / not / are / of



Extension Activity

Write about your favorite holiday/festival in your country.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Pick your favorite holiday or festival from your country.
- Answer five questions about your selection: What does the holiday mean? When is it? What do people usually do? Is there any special food? Is it a day off?
- Write out your answers.
- Have your partner ask you the questions.
- Answer the questions without reading from your written answers.
- Switch roles.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I practice asking questions.

☐ ☐

I talk about cultural items, icons and events.

☐ ☐

I explain my opinion.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **pageant** (noun): an elaborate performance featuring colorful costumes; beauty contest
e.g. We take our beauty pageants very seriously.
- **procession** (noun): a number of people and vehicles moving together as part of a ceremony
e.g. There are a lot of religious processions in my country.
- **ritual** (noun): a ceremony consisting of a series of actions performed according to a prescribed order
e.g. Does your family have any New Year's rituals?
- **ancestry** (noun): a person's family or ethnic descent
e.g. My ancestry is German, Irish and a little French.
- **influence** (noun): a person or thing that has an effect on your life
e.g. The Catholic influence is still very strong in Colombia.
- **indigenous** (adjective): where something is from; where something grows naturally
e.g. The kangaroo is indigenous to Australia.
- **reveler** (noun): a party goer
e.g. On the last day, the revelers paint each other black.





Learning Points

The Position of Not

In English, the adverb *not* usually goes after the auxiliary verb or "be" to form the negative.

You can use the adverb *not* in other positions in some cases.

Usually, we find the adverb *not* in conjunction with an auxiliary verb or "be" in a negative sentence.

Example:

*Well, we certainly do **not** have that in Boston*

*I'm **not** sure I heard about it.*

*I shouldn't eat this every week = I should **not** eat this every week.*

When you use the long form instead of the contraction, you emphasize the negation of the verb.

You also find *not* **before** a verb in the Infinitive.

Example:

*They are **not** to be missed.*

*It's better **not** to think about it, right?*





Learning Points

Should and Be Supposed To

You use the modal **should** or the structure **be supposed to** when you want to talk about expectations, obligations or arrangements.

You can use **be supposed to** to talk about situations in the present or future that are expected to happen.

The structure is:

Subject + To be + supposed to + verb

*Sharing information with their new colleagues is something they're **supposed to do** .*

****Pronunciation tip**:**

When you say be supposed to, you link the /d/ and /t/ sounds together.

Like this:

Be suppose_to

Examples:

- *We are supposed to think about the religious meaning of Easter.*
- *You should really see the festival. It is not something you experience every day.*

